

# MI TENSION SYSTEM

Modal interchange chords don't need a new tension set — use parent-key logic instead.

THE PARENT-KEY RULE

What mode am I borrowing from? → Find its RELATIVE MAJOR (parent key) →

Use THAT key's tension sets

WALKTHROUGH — BORROWING FROM C MINOR (PARALLEL MINOR OF C)

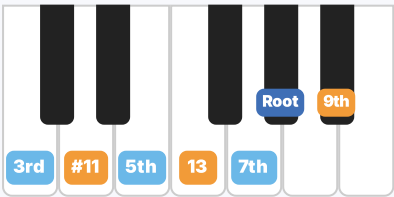
- BORROWING FROM: Parallel minor of C = **C minor**
- PARENT KEY: Relative major of C minor = **E♭ major** (3 flats)
- THEREFORE: Use **E♭ major's tension sets** for all borrowed chords
- EXAMPLE 1: **A♭maj7 (bVIImaj7 in C)** = IVmaj7 in E♭ → available tensions: 9, #11, 13
- EXAMPLE 2: **Fm7 (iv-7 in C)** = ii-7 in E♭ → available tensions: 9, 11
- EXAMPLE 3: **B♭7 (bVII7 in C)** = V7 in E♭ → available tensions: 9, 13

PARENT KEY REFERENCE — MOST COMMON MI SOURCES

| MODE BORROWED  | PARENT KEY | EXAMPLE CHORD IN C | PARENT FUNCTION | AVAILABLE TENSIONS |
|----------------|------------|--------------------|-----------------|--------------------|
| Parallel Minor | E♭ major   | A♭maj7 (bVIImaj7)  | IVmaj7 in E♭    | 9 #11 13           |
| Parallel Minor | E♭ major   | Fm7 (iv-7)         | ii-7 in E♭      | 9 11               |
| Parallel Minor | E♭ major   | B♭7 (bVII7)        | V7 in E♭        | 9 13               |
| Parallel Minor | E♭ major   | E♭maj7 (bIIImaj7)  | IImaj7 in E♭    | 9 13               |
| Lydian         | C major    | D7 (II7)           | V7/V in C       | 9 13               |
| Mixolydian     | F major    | B♭ (bVII)          | IVmaj7 in F     | 9 #11 13           |
| Phrygian       | A♭ major   | D♭maj7 (bII)       | IVmaj7 in A♭    | 9 #11 13           |

A♭maj7 in C major — Tensions from E♭ major (IVmaj7 logic)

Chord tones: A♭ · C · E♭ · G. Available tensions: B♭ (9), D (nat13 / #11), F (13)



■ Root (A♭) ■ Chord Tones ■ Available Tensions (9, #11, 13)

**This logic works for ALL modes** — just find the relative major (parent key) and look up what function the borrowed chord performs there. The whole-step rule still applies within the parent key. You never need to memorize a new tension set for modal interchange.